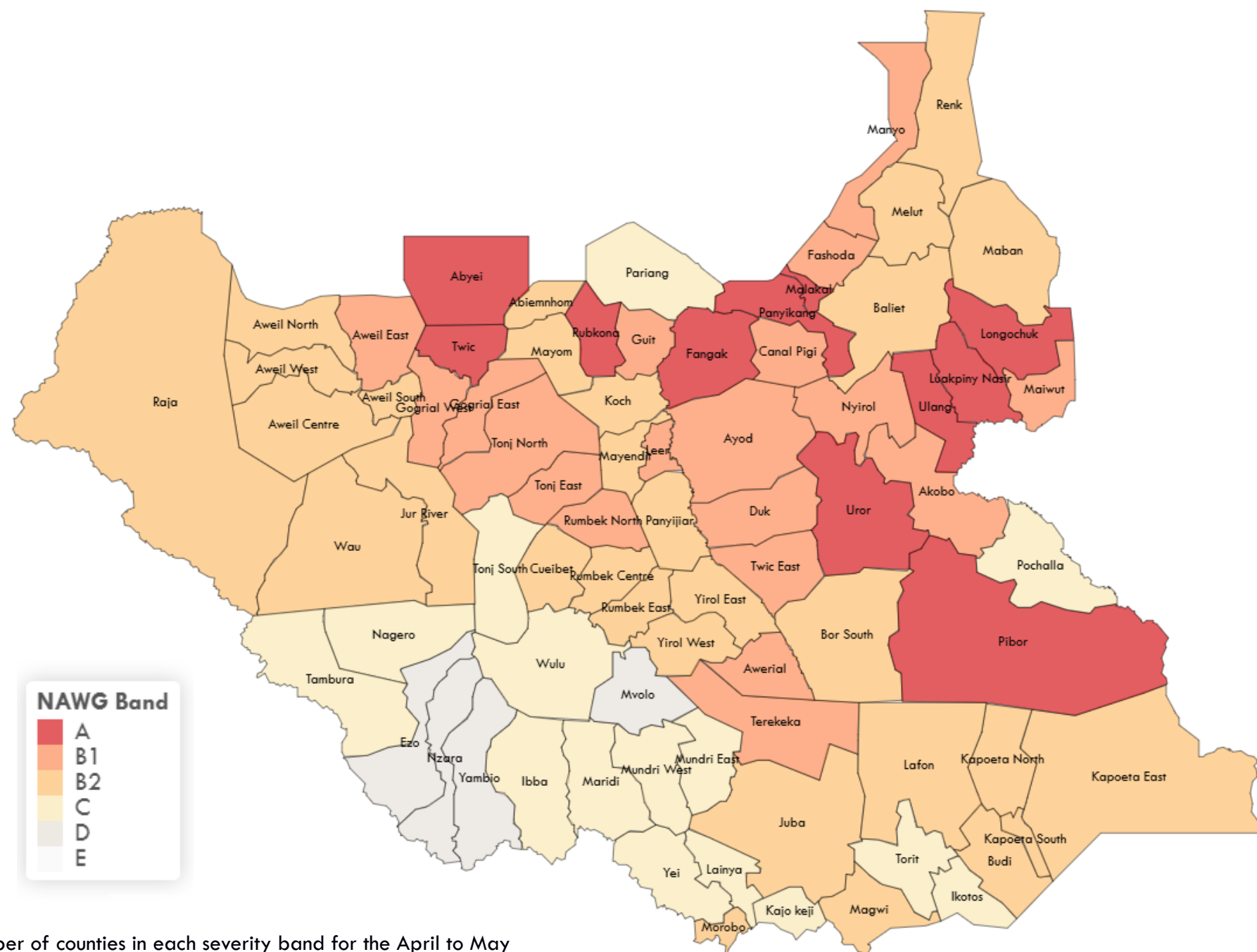
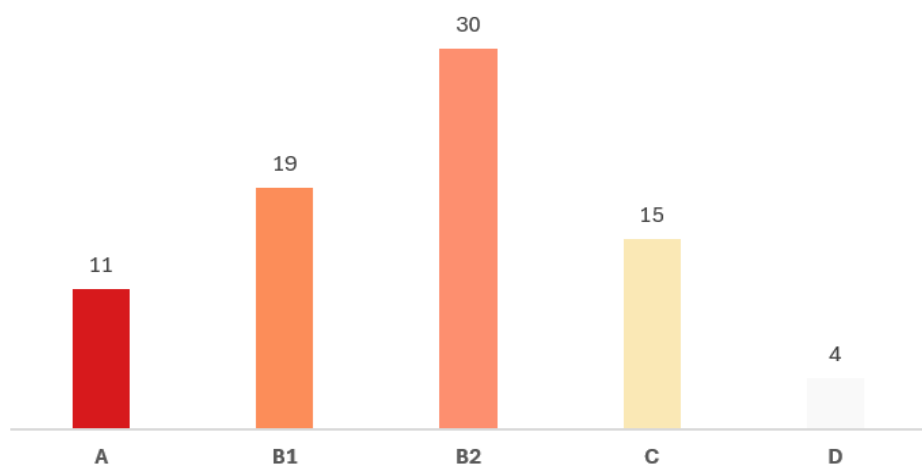


SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

April - May 2025 Analysis



Number of counties in each severity band for the April to May 2025 analysis period



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Felix Omunu (omunu@un.org) or Rebecca Hetzer (rebecca.hetzer@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on June 3rd, 2025 to discuss the analysis from the **April to May** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of essential needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMIMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from Clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used to estimate crude mortality

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

April - May 2025 Analysis

Counties facing “extreme” humanitarian conditions

The backend analysis classified nine counties in Band A (‘Extreme humanitarian conditions’): **Abyei, Malakal, Nasir, Panyikang, Pibor, Rubkona, Twic, Ulang and Uror.**

Following a detailed discussion and contextual analysis during the NAWG meeting, **Fangak** and **Longochuk** were also classified in Band A for exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A).

Discussion and joint analysis

- **Fangak:** The humanitarian situation deteriorated further in this analysis period, when aerial bombardment and violent clashes continued. An estimated 52,000 people have been displaced, mainly from New and Old Fangak. An influx of people in remote, under-resourced communities has strained the availability of food, water and shelter. Humanitarian access is heavily constrained. Violence, widespread displacement and severe flooding threaten extreme health outcomes. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Longochuk:** Airstrikes and armed violence in neighbouring counties displaced an estimated 18,000 people in Longochuk County between March and April. Armed clashes inside Longochuk in May displaced an unknown number of people into remote forested areas, and forced partners to suspend critical services. Agencies are struggling to verify and treat a cholera outbreak. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Tonj North:** Raiders killed three herders and looted 200 cattle in Ruelbet Payam in early April. Subsequent clashes resulted in a further three fatalities. Violence at the beginning of May displaced some 8,000 people in two payams. Humanitarian services have since resumed, according to partners. **Final classification: Maintain in Band B1.**
- **Juba:** Armed violence in a cantonment site in southern Juba displaced an unknown number of people. Meanwhile, partners reported that looting and violence were common on the main road in southern Juba. Clashes between cattle herders were reported, as was an influx of displaced persons fleeing clashes in Western Equatoria. Lastly, land grabs have reportedly displaced people to various ‘islands’ that are prone to flood in the coming months. **Final classification: Maintain in Band B2.**
- **Koch:** A storm in late May damaged some 300 houses in Koch Town and killed an unknown number of livestock. Nine education facilities were reportedly

destroyed, and two people lost their lives. Small-scale displacement (10-15 households) was also reported. **Final classification: Maintain in Band B2.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. **Partners are encouraged to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.**

- **Abyei (Band A):** Partners reported that armed groups from Sudan are present in Abyei. Further, a significant number of refugees and returnees have arrived from Sudan. Many of those people do not have a clear status, meaning they are not registered for humanitarian assistance.
- **Malakal (Band A):** The latest IPC analysis (October 2024) projected that 5% of the population in Malakal (10,000 people) would experience catastrophic food insecurity (Phase-5) between April and July 2025. Partners reported that a humanitarian partner was stopped and ordered to pay fines. Further, violence in northern Jonglei has obstructed supply chains between Bor and Malakal.
- **Nasir (Band A):** Aerial bombardment and armed clashes continued through the April-May period, albeit at a lower frequency than in previous periods. Partners reported that tens of thousands are displaced, including into Gambella region, Ethiopia. An IPC Update in May revealed exceptionally severe rates of acute food insecurity and acute malnutrition. Meanwhile, the Case Fatality Rate for cholera (7.6%) is extremely high. Humanitarian access is heavily constrained, though the government conducted several airdrops of food in Nasir Town in May.
- **Panyikang (Band A):** Frequent aerial bombardment continued throughout this analysis period. Armed clashes in several villages in April displaced up to 5,000 people into Sudan’s South Kordofan State, and an unknown number of people within Panyikang County, according to local authorities.
- **Pibor (Band A):** The latest IPC analysis (October 2024) projected that 5% of the population in Pibor (12,000 people) would experience catastrophic food insecurity (Phase-5) between April and July 2025. The situation in eastern Pibor remains a particular concern. Humanitarian agencies cannot access much of this area, and the road between eastern Pibor and Eastern Equatoria – an important trade route – has been closed since April 2024. Finally, some 600 returnees from Sudan and Uganda arrived in Pibor on June 2nd.

- **Ulang (Band A):** The population is reeling from a significant escalation of violence in March. Thousands remain displaced, and humanitarian access is heavily constrained. An IPC Update in May revealed exceptionally severe rates of acute food insecurity and acute malnutrition.
- **Uror (Band A):** The latest IPC analysis (October 2024) projected that 5% of the population in Uror would experience catastrophic food insecurity (Phase-5) between April and July 2025.
- **Akobo (Band B1):** Access constraints reportedly disrupted prepositioning efforts in Akobo East before the rainy season. In parallel, a drawdown in humanitarian food assistance in neighbouring Gambella region, Ethiopia, has reportedly driven an unknown number of people into Akobo.
- **Mayendit (Band B2):** Heavy rainfall and flash flooding between May 19-22 affected up to 5,000 people.
- **Morobo (Band B2):** Armed clashes have displaced some 18,000 people. Fighting displaced much of the population from Grilli, Kanja, Kindi and Panyume areas. Many fled into Uganda, according to a recent emergency assessment. A growing caseload, including 5,000 people who returned from Uganda on May 31st, threatens to overwhelm the limited humanitarian presence in Morobo, which was scaled back amid recent funding challenges.
- **Tonj East (Band B1):** Inter-communal clashes between May 28-29 displaced some 30,000 households, according to partners. The violence also resulted in at least 62 fatalities, as well as destruction of property. Clashes look set to resume in the near future.
- **Renk County (Band B2):** Partners reported a scale-down in onward transportation assistance for new arrivals from Sudan, due to a lack of funding. Meanwhile, several partners were forced to scale back lifesaving services, including basic healthcare and support for malnourished children. The latest IPC analysis (October 2024) classified 5% of returnees in IPC Acute Food Insecurity Phase-5 (Catastrophe). A highly vulnerable returnee population, a reduction in humanitarian services, and an ongoing cholera outbreak threaten severe health outcomes throughout the rainy season.